

△ proof why variance of Uniform distribution is  $\text{Var}(X) = \frac{(b-a)^2}{12}$

Let  $X$  be continuous random variable  $\Rightarrow$  then  $\text{Var}(X) = E(X^2) - (E(X))^2$

Consider  $\mu = E(X)$ . Let  $X$  have probability density function  $f_X$ .

[probability density function ( $f_X$ ): The probability density function of a continuous random variable  $X$  with support  $S$  is an integrable function  $f_X(x)$  satisfying the 2 conditions: 1  $\forall x \in S, f(x) > 0$  2 The area under the curve  $f(x)$  in the support  $S$  is 1,  $\int_S f_X(x) dx = 1$  3 the probability of  $X$  that  $X \in A$ , is  $\rightarrow P(X) = \int_A f_X(x) dx$

First we will prove the variance formula  $\Rightarrow \mu = E(X) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x f_X(x) dx$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Var}(X) &= E((X-\mu)^2) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (x-\mu)^2 f_X(x) dx = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (x^2 - 2\mu x + \mu^2) f_X(x) dx \\ &= \underbrace{\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x^2 f_X(x) dx}_{E(x^2)} - \underbrace{2\mu \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x f_X(x) dx}_{\mu} + \underbrace{\mu^2 \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_X(x) dx}_{=1} \\ &\quad - 2\mu^2 \end{aligned}$$

$$= E(x^2) - 2\mu^2 + \mu^2 = E(x^2) - \mu^2 = E(x^2) - (E(x))^2 \quad (*)$$

△ So for uniform distribution we know that  $E(X) = \frac{a+b}{2}$

$\Rightarrow \text{Var}(X) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x^2 f_X(x) dx - (E(X))^2$   $\Rightarrow$  we have that  $a \leq x \leq b$  so

$$\text{Var}(X) = \underbrace{\int_{-\infty}^a 0 x^2 dx}_{\text{out of range so } p(x)=0} + \int_a^b \frac{x^2}{b-a} dx + \underbrace{\int_b^{\infty} 0 x^2 dx}_{\text{out of range so } p(x)=0} - \left(\frac{a+b}{2}\right)^2$$

$$\Rightarrow \text{Var}(X) = \int_a^b \frac{x^2}{b-a} dx - \left(\frac{a+b}{2}\right)^2$$

$$= \frac{x^3}{3(b-a)} \Big|_a^b - \left(\frac{a+b}{2}\right)^2$$

$$= \frac{b^3}{3(b-a)} - \frac{a^3}{3(b-a)} - \frac{a^2+2ab+b^2}{4} = \frac{(b-a)(a^2+ab+b^2)}{3(b-a)} - \frac{a^2+2ab+b^2}{4}$$

$$= \frac{4(b-a)(a^2+ab+b^2)}{12(b-a)} - \frac{(a^2+2ab+b^2)}{4} = \frac{4a^2+4ab+4b^2-3a^2-6ab-3b^2}{12}$$

$$= \frac{b^2-2ab+a^2}{12} = \frac{(b-a)^2}{12} \quad \blacksquare \text{ we prove!}$$